# PetroChina (0857.HK): First Take: 3Q in line; FCF remains healthy; remain Buy

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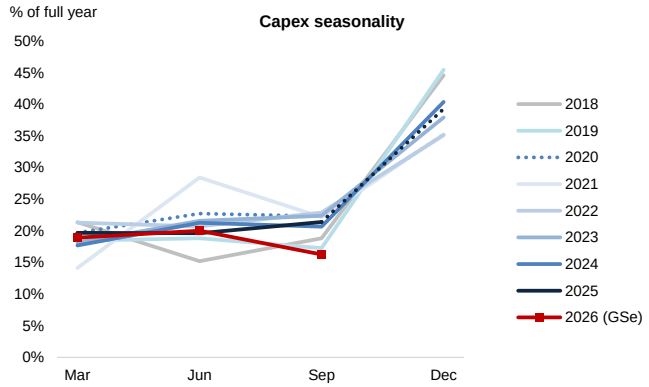
PetroChina's 3Q EBITDA was 2% higher than our expectation, mainly driven by upside surprise from the refining business, where both volumes and margins surprised to the upside (Exhibit 5-Exhibit 6). 3Q refinery runs was broadly flat yoy, better than -9% GSe; 3Q refining business EBIT per barrel realized at US$2.7, better than -US$1.8 GSe. 3Q ytd capex was 55% of our full year assumption, lower than the historical spending pattern of 62% (Exhibit 1). 3Q ytd FCF has remained robust, reaching 118% of our full year estimate (vs. 3Q ytd seasonal average at 112%, Exhibit 2-Exhibit 3).

We expect PetroChina to maintain robust cash flow generation, supported by our macro team's Brent price assumptions of US$80/bbl for 2027E and US$75/bbl over the long term. We remain Buy rated on PetroChina (H/A), whose cash flow could cover both our base case capex and dividend at below US$60/bbl Brent, while offering attractive 2027E FCF yield of 11%. PetroChina's valuation remains compelling at 3.8X FY27E EV/DACF, sitting at a marked discount to its global peer group average of 5.8X (Exhibit 7). We assess that the current share price of PetroChina (H) is discounting a long-term oil price of c.US$60/bbl.

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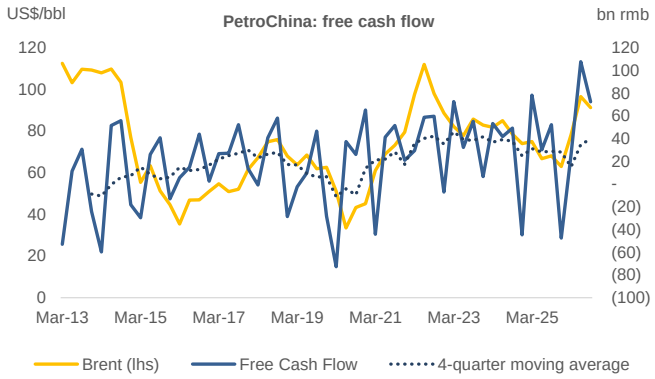
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### Exhibit 1: 3Q ytd capex was 55% of our full year assumption, lower than the historical spending pattern



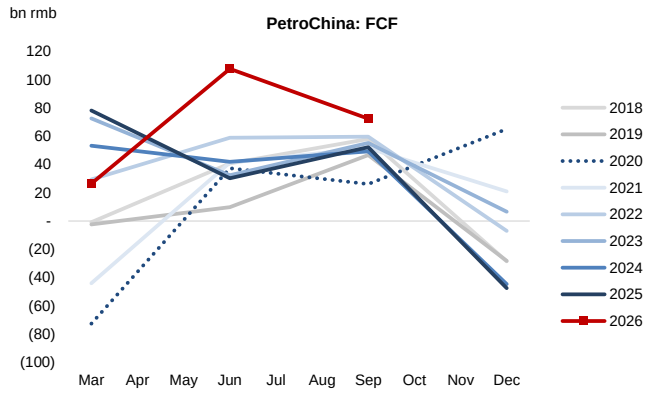

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

### Exhibit 2: PetroChina 3Q FCF remains at a healthy level



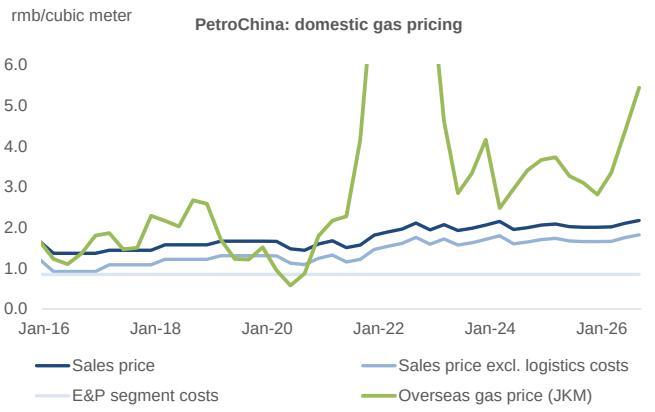

Source: Company data, Refinitiv

### Exhibit 3: 3Q ytd FCF has reached 118% of our full year estimate




Source: Company data

### Exhibit 4: PetroChina has seen higher domestic gas prices yoy in 3Q




Source: Company data, Refinitiv

### Exhibit 5: Summary of PetroChina's key financial metrics

| PetroChina Summary Financials | | Sep-24 Quarter | Dec-24 Quarter | Mar-25 Quarter | Jun-25 Quarter | Sep-25 Quarter | Dec-25 Quarter | Mar-26 Quarter | Jun-26 Quarter | Sep-26 Quarter | vs. GSe Sep-26 Est. | vs. GSe Var. Est. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Revenue** | **mn rmb** | **702,721** | **680,287** | **753,056** | **696,965** | **719,042** | **695,406** | **736,383** | **791,108** | **793,573** | **697,996** | 14% |
| COGS | mn rmb | (458,173) | (415,547) | (510,356) | (469,848) | (481,844) | (442,903) | (480,241) | (544,370) | (526,593) | (456,477) | 15% |
| **Gross profit** | **mn rmb** | **244,548** | **264,740** | **242,700** | **227,117** | **237,198** | **252,503** | **256,142** | **246,738** | **266,980** | **241,519** | 11% |
| Operating expenses | mn rmb | (123,642) | (150,384) | (115,657) | (113,622) | (121,639) | (141,234) | (125,737) | (112,232) | (140,887) | (118,147) | 19% |
| **EBITDA** | **mn rmb** | **120,906** | **114,356** | **127,043** | **113,495** | **115,559** | **111,269** | **130,405** | **134,506** | **126,093** | **123,372** | **2%** |
| DD&A | mn rmb | (57,861) | (56,869) | (61,068) | (60,972) | (57,098) | (58,889) | (63,804) | (61,724) | (57,136) | (57,417) | 0% |
| **EBIT** | **mn rmb** | **63,045** | **57,487** | **65,975** | **52,523** | **58,461** | **52,380** | **66,601** | **72,782** | **68,957** | **65,955** | 5% |
| Non-operating income | mn rmb | 830 | (9,265) | 1,655 | 2,402 | 2,058 | (9,289) | 2,339 | 4,143 | 2,366 | 1,941 | 22% |
| **Pre Tax Profit** | **mn rmb** | **63,875** | **48,222** | **67,630** | **54,925** | **60,519** | **43,091** | **68,940** | **76,925** | **71,323** | **67,896** | 5% |
| Tax expense | mn rmb | (15,165) | (12,986) | (15,100) | (12,597) | (13,709) | (12,738) | (15,462) | (15,290) | (14,459) | (15,664) | -8% |
| Non-controlling interest | mn rmb | (4,728) | (3,340) | (5,078) | (4,595) | (4,162) | (868) | (5,145) | (6,032) | (5,024) | (4,488) | 12% |
| **Reported net income** | **mn rmb** | **43,982** | **31,896** | **47,452** | **37,733** | **42,648** | **29,485** | **48,333** | **55,603** | **51,840** | **47,743** | **9%** |
| | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Reported EPS** | **rmb/sh** | **0.24** | **0.17** | **0.26** | **0.21** | **0.23** | **0.16** | **0.26** | **0.30** | **0.28** | **0.26** | **9%** |

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research



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**Exhibit 6: Summary of PetroChina's segment performance**

| PetroChina Segment Data | | Sep-24 Quarter | Dec-24 Quarter | Mar-25 Quarter | Jun-25 Quarter | Sep-25 Quarter | Dec-25 Quarter | Mar-26 Quarter | Jun-26 Quarter | Sep-26 Quarter | vs. GSe Sep-26 Quarter | vs. GSe Var. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| EBITDA | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Exploration and production | mn rmb | 101,361 | 63,781 | 95,452 | 88,827 | 88,774 | 57,972 | 90,769 | 109,127 | 97,196 | 103,749 | -6,553 |
| Refining and chemicals | mn rmb | 9,203 | 13,658 | 11,885 | 12,165 | 12,879 | 15,702 | 15,665 | 13,624 | 16,302 | 6,143 | 10,159 |
| Marketing | mn rmb | 7,565 | 8,363 | 9,474 | 6,950 | 8,513 | 10,370 | 10,634 | 9,057 | 7,586 | 7,896 | -310 |
| Natural gas sales | mn rmb | 10,212 | 30,491 | 14,655 | 6,265 | 14,231 | 31,101 | 20,021 | 6,374 | 10,800 | 7,970 | 2,830 |
| Head office and other | mn rmb | -2,042 | -7,329 | -4,470 | -663 | -2,892 | -9,819 | -7,723 | -2,635 | -3,208 | -2,386 | -822 |
| **Total** | **mn rmb** | **126,299** | **108,964** | **126,995** | **113,543** | **121,504** | **105,325** | **129,365** | **135,546** | **128,675** | **123,372** | **5,303** |

* Total quarterly EBITDA of segments are slightly different from the company total due to a lack of quarterly disclosure of DD&A by segment.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 7: PetroChina's cash flow multiple remains low among global peers**

| | | 2027 FCF Yield (%) | 2027 Dividend Yield (%) | 2027 EV/DACF (X) | 2026 EV/GCI (X) | EV/1P Reserves ($/BOE) | 2027 CROCI (%) | 2026 Net Debt / Equity (%) | 2024-27E E&P Volume Growth CAGR (%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **A** | **Chinese Big Oils** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | CNOOC | 14% | 7% | 3.2X | 0.45X | 21.6 | 13% | (12%) | 5% |
| 2 | PetroChina | 11% | 6% | 3.8X | 0.35X | 14.7 | 9% | 4% | 2% |
| 3 | Sinopec | 5% | 6% | 4.5X | 0.31X | | 6% | 36% | 2% |
| **B** | **India/ASEAN Oils** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | PTTEP | 6% | 5% | 4.1X | 0.33X | 12.7 | 8% | 7% | 5% |
| 2 | PTT | 9% | 8% | 6.4X | 0.51X | | 8% | 35% | |
| 3 | ONGC | 14% | 7% | 4.2X | 0.46X | 7.6 | 11% | 32% | (0%) |
| **C** | **Upstream** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | ConocoPhillips | 8% | 2% | 6.9X | 0.99X | 29.6 | 13% | 21% | 7% |
| 2 | Chevron Corp | 8% | 3% | 7.5X | 1.03X | 39.7 | 13% | 8% | 8% |
| **D** | **Integrated Oil** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | Shell | 13% | 3% | 4.9X | 0.64X | 33.1 | 12% | 15% | 3% |
| 2 | BP | 14% | 4% | 4.1X | 0.48X | 20.7 | 11% | 17% | (1%) |
| 3 | Exxon Mobil | 6% | 2% | 9.8X | 1.29X | 41.6 | 12% | 6% | 6% |
| 4 | TotalEnergies | 11% | 5% | 5.8X | 0.58X | 19.5 | 9% | 18% | 4% |
| **E** | **Downstream** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | Phillips 66 | 11% | 2% | 7.6X | 1.67X | | 20% | 40% | |
| 2 | Marathon Petroleum | 11% | 1% | 7.8X | 1.71X | | 20% | 78% | |
| 3 | Neste | 13% | 5% | 6.0X | 1.05X | | 16% | 16% | |
| | **Average** | **10%** | **5%** | **5.8X** | **0.79X** | **24.1** | **12%** | **21%** | **4%** |

Green represents top quartile among global peers.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

PetroChina is a state-owned integrated oil and gas company in China, operating E&P, refining, and downstream distribution businesses nationwide. We are Buy-rated on PetroChina (H/A), whose cash flow could cover both our base case capex and dividend at less than US$60/bbl Brent, while offering attractive dividend yield. PetroChina is supported by robust upstream gas earnings and significant cost-saving potential, via replacing external grid power with self-generated green power, alongside AI/digital initiatives. Downside risks: Lower oil prices than expected; more competitive global gas market leading to gas earnings headwinds over the medium term.

Our 12-month target prices for the H/A shares are HK$12.10/Rmb15.50 based on a sum-of-the-parts (SOTP) methodology, with the valuation base year being blended 2027E/28E. For the E&P segment, we continue to use 50% DCF + 50% EV/DACF in valuation. We use a 3.5X EV/DACF multiple for the 50% blend component of E&P valuations, in line with how we value upstream pure-play E&P names like ONGC. We apply a 3.9X target EV/EBITDA multiple for its refining & chemical and marketing segments. We apply a 4.0X EV/EBITDA multiple for the natural gas segments, at a



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discount to regional peers, to reflect LNG import losses. We also apply an A-share premium of 39%.

Key downside risks: Downside risks: Lower oil prices than expected; more competitive global gas market leading to gas earnings headwinds over the medium term.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **0857.HK** | 12m Price Target: **HK$12.10** | Price: **HK$9.95** | Upside: **21.6%** |
| **601857.SS** | 12m Price Target: **Rmb15.50** | Price: **Rmb13.26** | Upside: **16.9%** |

**Buy**

Market cap: HK$1.8tr / $232.1bn
Enterprise value: HK$2.2tr / $277.8bn
3m ADTV: HK$742.7mn / $94.7mn
China
Asia Energy & Chemicals
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

## GS Forecast

| | 12/25 | 12/26E | 12/27E | 12/28E |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue (Rmb mn) | 2,864,469.0 | 3,015,561.0 | 2,995,872.3 | 2,927,948.5 |
| EBITDA (Rmb mn) | 467,366.0 | 519,099.1 | 528,153.9 | 544,627.5 |
| EPS (Rmb) | 0.86 | 1.05 | 1.08 | 1.12 |
| P/E (X) | 7.5 | 8.1 | 7.8 | 7.5 |
| P/B (X) | 0.7 | 0.9 | 0.9 | 0.8 |
| Dividend yield (%) | 7.3 | 6.3 | 6.6 | 6.9 |
| N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X) | 0.1 | (0.1) | (0.2) | (0.4) |
| CROCI (%) | 9.0 | 9.0 | 8.7 | 8.6 |
| FCF yield (%) | 8.1 | 9.9 | 10.0 | 10.9 |

| | 3/26 | 6/26 | 9/26E | 12/26E |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| EPS (Rmb) | 0.26 | 0.30 | 0.26 | 0.22 |

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 28 Oct 2026 close.



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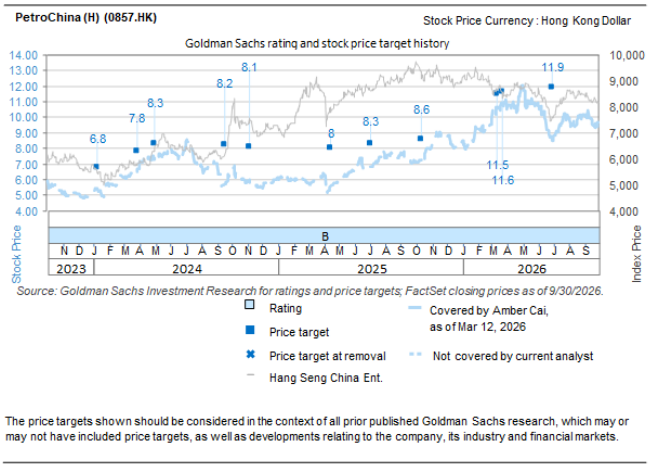
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|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
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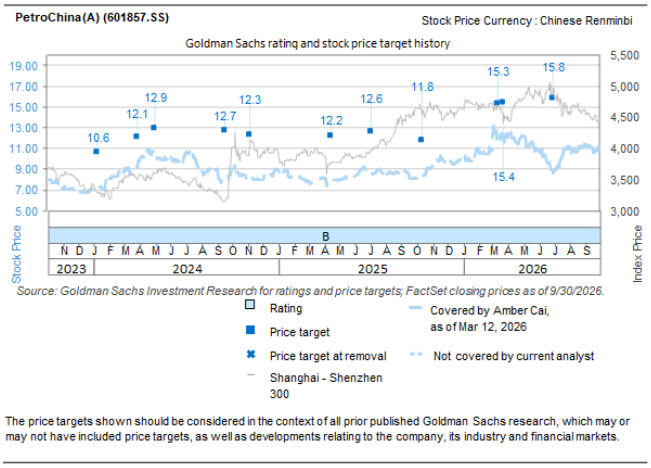
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## Target price history table(s)

### PetroChina (H) (0857.HK)

| Date of report | Target price (HK$) | Closing price (HK$) |
|---|---|---|
| 16-Oct-26 | 12.10 | 10.00 |
| 30-Jun-26 | 11.90 | 8.48 |
| 23-Mar-26 | 11.60 | 10.76 |
| 12-Mar-26 | 11.50 | 10.62 |
| 14-Oct-25 | 8.60 | 7.21 |
| 04-Jul-25 | 8.30 | 6.81 |
| 15-Apr-25 | 8.00 | 5.58 |
| 05-Nov-24 | 8.10 | 5.98 |
| 17-Sep-24 | 8.20 | 5.75 |
| 02-May-24 | 8.30 | 7.10 |
| 27-Mar-24 | 7.80 | 6.47 |
| 09-Jan-24 | 6.80 | 5.38 |

### PetroChina (A) (601857.SS)

| Date of report | Target price (Rmb) | Closing price (Rmb) |
|---|---|---|
| 16-Oct-26 | 15.50 | 12.76 |
| 30-Jun-26 | 15.80 | 8.68 |
| 23-Mar-26 | 15.40 | 12.34 |
| 12-Mar-26 | 15.30 | 12.23 |
| 14-Oct-25 | 11.80 | 8.33 |
| 04-Jul-25 | 12.60 | 8.60 |
| 15-Apr-25 | 12.20 | 7.75 |
| 05-Nov-24 | 12.30 | 8.28 |
| 17-Sep-24 | 12.70 | 7.90 |
| 02-May-24 | 12.90 | 10.27 |
| 27-Mar-24 | 12.10 | 9.17 |
| 09-Jan-24 | 10.60 | 7.46 |

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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